

Mad scramble for porn

ICM Registry has received nearly 9,00,000 interested buyers for .XXX domain names during its pre-reservation process

Paid torrents?

The new paid version of uTorrent is expected to offer better media management and encoding facilities

Gaming Laptops

springier keys. There are some shortcut buttons, but not like the touch keys on the GX660, GT680R and GX780R. There's a trackpad on/off switch between the trackpad and the keypad. The GT540M makes the GE620 a reasonably potent gaming package but it's an inconspicuous look that doesn't grab attention like other gaming notebooks. The GE620 was the only notebook that came with just 4 GB of RAM; all the others had at least 8 GB. This was also the only notebook that failed 3D Mark 11, but for unknown reasons – and this had nothing to do with its configuration, which is certainly good enough to run this benchmark properly.

If you're looking for a no-frills gaming notebook, the GE620 is certainly no slouch. With 50.1 fps in *S.T.A.L.K.E.R. Call Of Pripyat* at a resolution of 1366x768 pixels at medium settings, the GE620 is definitely capable of handling most current generation games at medium levels. Its price is the main attraction, and makes it appealing for those who don't want to break the bank. How-

ever, it's not a beast by any stretch, and if you're looking to play games like *Metro 2033* or *Crysis 2* with eye-candy enabled, you'll need something more potent.

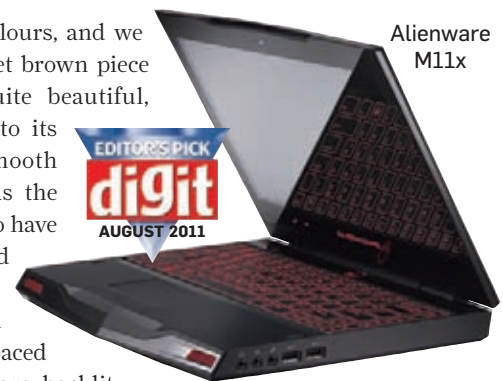
Alienware M11x: ₹64,900

The M11x might have a small display but isn't really compact. This is a chunky little fella, and we don't mean that in a bad way, for the M11x will grab your attention and hold it. The lines are straight, and while the lid curves at the sides, it slopes forward aggressively from the front to meet the body, which also slopes forward. The embedded lights in the front give the impression of a sports car bonnet, much as Alienware (probably) intended. It's easy to appreciate the clean lines and design aesthetics, just as easy as it is to appreciate the rugged exterior and the resilient smooth finish that oozes appeal. There's great attention to detail – heck there are even two memory card slots, one for MS Pro cards and the other for SD cards.

Alienware allows custom-

ising surface colours, and we received a russet brown piece that looked quite beautiful, especially due to its rubberised smooth finish. This was the only notebook to have both, HDMI and display port connects, with all ports well spaced out. The keys are backlit but aren't very spaced; and while each key is fairly large, the lack of space around them is counterproductive, and makes typing a bit of a chore. Comparatively, the M17x is much better for typing.

Despite its small size, the M11x packs a fair wallop in terms of its under-the-hood components. You get a quad-core Core i7 2720QM clocked at 2.2 GHz – quite a potent CPU even for a gaming notebook. Despite its relatively diminutive form, the M11x also includes 8 GB of DDR3 1333 MHz memory and an NVIDIA GeForce GT555M graphic card. And all this is a package that weighs a mere two kilograms, making the M11x quite portable, though



Alienware M11x

netbook-grade portability is still a distant dream, and understandably so. The quality of the display is commendable – good colour, brightness and contrast; however, most of us found it a little small for gaming.

With 54.2 fps in *Far Cry 2* and 49.7 fps in *S.T.A.L.K.E.R. Call Of Pripyat* at 1366x768 pixels with medium levels of detail, the M11x is certainly not for the hardcore gamer who demands utmost visual quality, but for most lesser mortals it will do the job. Still a graphics score of just 805 in 3D Mark 11 will just not do for someone looking to play the latest games at higher levels of detail. Similarly, an average score of 13.2 fps in Unigine 2.5 is mediocre at best.

HOW WE TESTED

We started with a clean install of Windows 7 Ultimate 64 bit. Each of the notebooks was formatted, and two partitions of equal sizes made. The latest drivers available from manufacturers' web sites were used. For graphics drivers, we used the latest ones from the respective GPU makers' web sites. All benchmarks were installed on the secondary partition. Options such as System Restore and Remote Login were disabled.

After an install of all the game benchmarks and copying of whatever files were required for the test, we did a disk clean-up, followed by a defragmentation of both partitions and a scandisk. Within Windows power profiles, all performance-sapping settings were turned off, and we disabled all settings like turning off disks or displays after a set period of time.

While we log all component specifications, we don't assign scores to all these values. Instead, some of these are considered, while others are

not. For example, we assigned a weight to hard drive size, but not number of CPU cores. This is because the former affects only storage quantity – a factor we don't test, while the latter affects CPU performance – something we actively test.

The second section consisted of the build and finish of the notebook. These scores were based on observations such as plastic or metal body. We also rated usability – how well laid out the keypad is, how well spaced the keys are, how many shortcut keys are provided and how useful they are – all points were considered and rated. These individual scores are comparative, so if a notebook got a trackpad accuracy score of 8, while another got a score of 6, this means notebook number 1 was better than notebook 2 by this percentile.

Finally, our performance tests consisted of a gamut of synthetic and real world tests. We included three new benchmarks – *Dirt 3*, which

is a new game, 3D Mark 11 – the latest from Futuremark Corp. and Unigine Heaven 2.5 – the latest version of Unigine's engine/benchmark. Two popular first person titles – *Far Cry 2* and *Call Of Pripyat* were used. For 3D Mark 11, we used a resolution of 1366x768 pixels, with "professional" preset. For Unigine Heaven 2.5, we used a resolution of 1366x768 while enabling 4x Anisotropic Filtering and DX11 mode. For those notebooks whose displays supported full HD, we ran each game at this setting as well, with eye candy set to maximum. Our file copy test consisted of copying a single .RAR file for the sequential test and a bunch of files for the non-sequential test. In case the notebook had a single HDD, we copied within the primary partition only. In case of two drives, we copied from one drive to another, except in case of RAID, where we copied within the primary partition. Imtec Battery Mark 1.1 was used for the battery test.